

Security Awareness Culture



Why Culture Matters

Your company can invest in firewalls, antivirus, and spam filters—but none of it works if people aren't alert.

Most data breaches happen not because of weak technology—but because of human error.

That's why building a security-aware culture is just as important as buying new security tools.



What is a Security-Aware Culture?

- People think before they click.
- Security is part of everyday conversations—not just annual training.
- Employees look out for one another, not just themselves.
- Reporting suspicious behavior is encouraged, not ignored.



Ways You Can Help Build That Culture

- Lead by Example
 - Pause before clicking, double-check senders, report suspicious emails.
 - Others will follow your behavior—especially if you're a team lead or manager.



Ways You Can Help Build That Culture

- Encourage Open Communication
 - Normalize asking: “Does this look suspicious to you?”
 - Never shame someone for clicking a phishing link—turn it into a learning moment.



**SECURITY
AWARENESS**

PROTECTING OUR WORKPLACE TOGETHER

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Ways You Can Help Build That Culture

- Share What You Learn
 - Forward real phishing examples to your team with a quick analysis (“Notice the sender’s domain? Total giveaway!”)
 - Help less technical coworkers understand what to look out for.



Ways You Can Help Build That Culture

- Support Training Efforts
 - Attend optional security workshops or lunch-and-learns.
 - Help organize short sessions for your team (even 10 minutes makes a difference).
 - Praise coworkers who spot and report phishing—make security a team win.



Ways You Can Help Build That Culture

- Help Remove the Stigma
 - Everyone makes mistakes—yes, even cybersecurity professionals.
 - The goal is to detect and respond quickly, not pretend we're perfect.



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Key Takeaway

Security isn't just the job of the IT department. Every click, every report, every conversation helps protect your organization. You're part of the firewall.



End of Lesson Prompt

What's one thing you could do this week to make your team more security-aware?

- Share a tip?
- Ask about a weird email together?
- Help someone check their links?

